UNDR

# NYC after dark. No fake ID needed.

A live map of the places in New York that actually let you in at 18, checked against each venue's fine print and confirmed at the door by people under 21.

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## THE PROBLEM

I'm 19. I spent two months living in New York this term and the city basically shut at 10pm for me. Bars, clubs, rooftops, most comedy clubs: all 21+. What annoyed me is that once I started paying attention, a lot of the city does let you in. Bowery Ballroom runs 18+ shows. Smalls, the jazz club, is all ages. The Whitney is free on Friday nights. The karaoke rooms in K-town don't check ID at all. None of that is secret, it just sits in ticket fine print and venue FAQs where nobody my age reads it, so we assume the answer is no and stay in. There are around 600,000 college students in NYC, plus the exchange cohorts and interns who land here from places where 18 is adult. Everyone I know hit this wall in week one.

## THE SOLUTION

UNDR is a map of what opens its doors at 18, tonight. Every spot shows the door policy, where I got it from, and how many under-21s have tapped "I got in". A toggle shows the 21+ places greyed out, so you can see how much of the city is locked. It also pulls real NYC Parks events from NYC Open Data (194 this week, all free), builds a three-stop night under whatever budget you give it with subway times between stops, and has a concierge you can talk to. Ask it "can I get into House of Yes?" and it says no, then tells you where to go instead. If someone gets turned away, they flag it and the listing drops out.

## WHY IT'S A BUSINESS

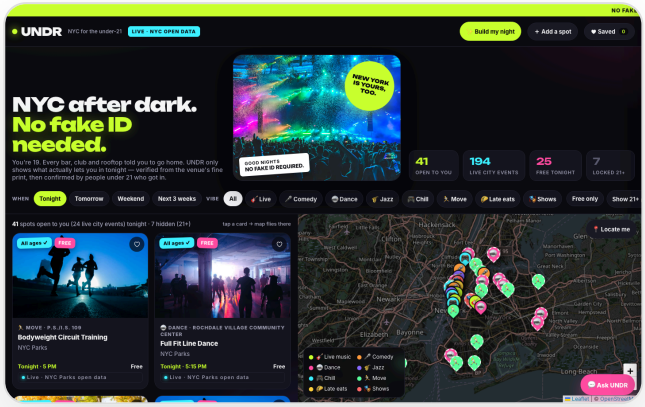
Venues have dead weeknights and ignore the people who can't drink but will still pay for a ticket, dinner and a karaoke room. UNDR charges venues for promoted weeknight listings and takes a cut on tickets. Campus partnerships come after that. What nobody else has is the data: door policies checked against the fine print, plus real confirmations from people under 21.

## MY PROCESS

- Kept a note of every place that let me in this semester. The pattern was that the information existed, it was just hidden.
- Brainstormed about 30 pain points with AI and checked the top five for competitors. There are NYC nightlife apps (Intoit, The Scene). None of them care how old you are.
- Built the first version in an afternoon, clicked through every flow on my laptop and my phone, then added the open data feed, a database and the deployment.

## AI TOOLKIT, HONESTLY

- Claude Code did the competitor research, wrote the code, tested it in a browser, set up the Supabase database and deployed to Vercel. The concierge inside the app runs on Claude or Gemini.
- OpenAI Codex built a second prototype so I could compare two designs. I took its idea of using NYC Open Data.
- Me: the problem, because I lived it for two months and kept the receipts. I walked into these places and noted who checked ID and who didn't; that door-policy list is mine. I ran two AI prototypes against each other (Claude and Codex), picked the stronger one and took the best idea from the other. Every product call was mine: what counts as verified, the locked view, the got-in loop, the look. I set up Supabase and Vercel, shipped it, broke it on my phone, got it fixed, and wrote this.




The live app: tonight's verified spots, the map, and a venue sheet with the door policy, its source and confirmations.

### TRY IT

**LIVE** **undr-nine.vercel.app** (works on your phone)

What it does: shows every spot in NYC that lets you in at 18, tonight, on a map, with the door policy and who confirmed it.
How to use it: tap a card and the map flies there. Hit **Build my night** for a three-stop plan under your budget. Flip **Show 21+** to see the locked city. Tap **Ask UNDR** and talk to it. Tap **I got in** at the door so the next person knows.

Free APIs only: OpenStreetMap, Nominatim, NYC Open Data, browser location and speech. Supabase stores the confirmations. Source code on request.

What's real and what's seeded: the 28 venues, addresses and door policies are real and I checked them. The city events are live. The got-in counts and the specific concert nights are placeholders to show the mechanic.